

考研精读 | Economist



Recipe for trouble

麻烦的菜谱

From **protein** to matcha, food fads spread faster than ever

蛋白质到抹茶，食品潮流传播速度史无前例

难度评级：★★★★☆

【 Para.1 】

Pigs were once the biggest consumers of **whey**, a **byproduct** of cheesemaking. Now farmers can scarcely afford it. Demand for whey **concentrate**, a common ingredient in gym shakes, has **soared** amid the craze for consuming more protein. Dairies have not scaled up cheese production to match. The price of whey protein thus rose fivefold in the three years to June, according to Vesper, a research firm. The great **comeback** of cottage cheese, which TikTok influencers also recommend for **bulking up**, has seen a similar shortage.

乳清是奶酪制作过程中的副产品，猪曾经是其最大消费者，而如今农户却几乎承担不起了。在“高蛋白”饮食热潮的推动下，作为健身奶昔常见配料的浓缩乳清需求量大幅飙升。然而，乳制品生产商并没有相应

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文章导读：

从蛋白粉到抹茶，社交媒体让食品潮流传播速度大幅提升。网红爆款快速催生巨大需求，但农业与食品供应链扩张缓慢，造成原料短缺、价格上涨。企业开始监测网络热点、提前锁定供应商或跨界合作抢抓风口；不过部分跟风产品也会因口碑问题很快下架，追逐网红饮食风潮存在风险。

protein n. /'prəʊti:n/ a natural substance found in meat, eggs, fish, some vegetables, etc. There are many different proteins and they are an essential part of what humans and animals eat to help them grow and stay healthy. 蛋白质（注意重音）

whey n. /wei/ the thin liquid that is left from sour milk after the solid part (called curds) has been removed 乳清，乳水（酸奶中的凝乳去掉后剩下的含水成分）

byproduct n. /'baɪ prɒdʌkt/ something that is produced during the manufacture or processing of another product. 副产品

concentrate n. /'kɒnsntreɪt/ a substance that is made stronger because water or other substances have been removed 浓缩物

soar v. /sɔ:(r)/ /sɔ:(r)/ if the value, amount or level of sth soars, it rises very quickly 急升；猛增

Food prices **soared** as the military authorities withdrew available stocks from the commercial market. 随着军事当局从商业市场撤出可用库存，食品价格飙升。

SYN rocket

comeback n. /'kʌmbæk/ an attempt to become famous, powerful, or important again after a period of being much less famous, etc. 复辟；复出；东山再起

bulk up phrasal verb if someone bulks up or if they bulk up their body, they put on weight in the form of extra muscle. 使变粗壮；变粗壮

My friend is obsessed with going to the gym and has really **bulk up** her arms. 我朋友迷上了去健身房，她确实把胳膊练得粗壮了。

illustrate v. /'ɪləstreɪt/ to show that sth is true or that a situation exists 表明...真实；显示...存在

The incident **illustrates** the need for better security measures. 这次事件说明了加强安全措施的必要。

v. to make the meaning of sth clearer by using examples, pictures, etc. (用示例、图画等) 说明，解释

Last year's sales figures are **illustrated** in Figure 2. 图2显示了去年的销售数字。

scale v. /skeɪl/ to change the size of sth 改变...的大小

Text can be scaled from 4 points to 108 points without any loss of quality. 正文可以从4点变到108点，但印刷质量丝毫不会降低。

scale sth ← → down phrasal verb (NAmE also scale sth ← → back) to reduce the number, size or extent of sth 减少（数量）；缩小（规模或范围）

扩大奶酪产量。据研究机构 Vesper 统计，截至今年 6 月，乳清蛋白的价格在三年内上涨至五倍。同样，在 TikTok 网红博主们推荐下，茅屋奶酪也作为增肌食品强势回归，并出现了类似的供应短缺。

【 Para.2 】

Both cases **illustrate** a new problem for the food-and-drinks industry. Online trends can build demand for ingredients faster than ever before, but farms and factories cannot **scale** production at the same speed. Firms are adapting by learning to anticipate trends and **ride** them **out** before consumers move on.

上两个案例都揭示出餐饮行业当下面临的新问题。即网络潮流能以迅雷不及掩耳之势拉高某些原料的需求，但农场和工厂的扩产速度远远跟不上需求。为适应这种变化，许多企业正学习预测潮流，并在消费者转移兴趣之前顺势赚足这波红利。

【 Para.3 】

Food **fads** are hardly new. Pineapples were so **coveted** in Georgian England that rental shops opened **peddling** display fruits. Swiss **fondue**, a hit with Americans in the 1960s and 70s, resulted in millions of cheese-melting pots that now **languish** in cupboards. Today, though, social media spreads such trends across the world in weeks. When a video of a **pistachio-pastry** chocolate bar made in Dubai **went viral** on TikTok in 2023, it was viewed more than 100m times. Months later top chocolatiers were selling their own versions, **straining** global pistachio production.

ride sth↔out *phrasal verb* to manage to survive a difficult situation or time without having to make great changes 安然渡过（难关）；经受得住
Many companies did not manage to **ride out** the recession. 经济衰退时期，许多公司没能渡过难关。

fad *n.* /fæd/ something that people are interested in for only a short period of time 一时的风尚；短暂的狂热

covet *v.* /'kavət/ to want to have something very much, especially something that belongs to someone else 觊觎，垂涎（尤指他人之物）；贪求，渴望
She always **coveted** power but never quite achieved it. 她一直贪求权力，但从未得逞。

peddle *v.* /'pedl/ to try to sell goods by going from house to house or from place to place 挨户销售；巡回销售
He worked as a door-to-door salesman **peddling** cloths and brushes. 他的工作是上门推销抹布和刷子。
v. to spread an idea or story in order to get people to accept it 兜售，宣传，传播（思想、消息）
This line (= publicly stated opinion) is being **peddled** by all the government spokesmen. 所有的政府发言人都在宣扬这个官方路线。

fondue *n.* /'fɒndju:/ a Swiss dish of melted cheese and wine into which pieces of bread are dipped 奶酪火锅（瑞士特色菜，蘸面包片吃）

languish *v.* /'læŋɡwɪʃ/ (~ in sth) to be forced to stay somewhere or suffer sth unpleasant for a long time 被迫滞留；长期受苦；受煎熬
She continues to **languish** in a foreign prison. 她被继续囚禁在一所外国的监狱里。

pistachio *n.* /prɪ'stæʃiəʊ/ (pl.-os) the small green nut of an Asian tree 开心果

pastry *n.* /'peɪstri/ (pl.-ies) a mixture of flour, fat and water or milk that is rolled out flat and baked as a base or covering for pies, etc. 油酥面团；油酥面皮

go viral *idiom* to become very popular very quickly 病毒式传播；迅速走红
The dance challenge **went viral** within hours, with millions of users posting their own versions. 那段舞蹈挑战在几小时内爆红，数百万用户上传了自己的版本。

chocolatier *n.* /'tʃɒkə'leɪtɪə, 'ʃɒkəlatje/ a person or company that makes or sells chocolate 制作或销售巧克力的人或公司

strain *v.* /streɪn/ to try to make sth do more than it is able to do 过度使用；使不堪承受
The sudden influx of visitors is **straining** hotels in the town to the limit. 游客突然涌入，城里的旅馆全都爆满。

v. (~ sth) (for sth) (~ sth) (to do sth) to make an effort to do sth, using all your mental or physical strength 尽力；竭力；使劲
Necks were **strained** for a glimpse of the stranger. 大家伸长了脖子想看一看这个陌生人。

prone *adj.* /prəʊn/ (~ to sth/to do sth) likely to suffer from sth or to do sth bad 易于遭受；有做（坏事）的倾向

ube *n.* /'u:bi/ a type of yam (= a root vegetable) that is purple in colour
The bakery's bestseller is a soft roll filled with sweet **ube** paste and cheese. 这家面包店最畅销的是夹有甜紫薯泥和奶酪的软面包。

食品潮流绝非新鲜事。在乔治王时代的英格兰，菠萝备受追捧，甚至出现了专门出租菠萝供人展示的店铺。20 世纪 60 年代和 70 年代，瑞士奶酪火锅风靡美国，催生出的融奶酪锅数以百万计，而如今，其大多只能在橱柜中闲置。到如今，社交媒体仅需短短几周就能让这类食物潮流席卷全球。2023 年，一段在迪拜制作的开心果酥皮巧克力棒的视频在 TikTok 上走红，观看次数超过 1 亿次。几个月后，各大顶级巧克力商纷纷推出自家版本，导致全球开心果的供应和生产承受了巨大压力。

【 Para.4 】

Food and drinks are especially **prone** to going viral. Grass-green matcha or violet **ube** lattes make for pleasing Instagram snaps. They are also cheap enough to be accessible. Bought once, even a \$19 strawberry from Japan won't break the bank. Young buyers, who spend a good deal of their lives on social media, are also more **inclined** towards **novelty**, notes Dan Frommer, author of "The New Consumer", a blog.

食品和饮料尤其容易成为网络爆款。草绿色的抹茶拿铁或紫罗兰色的香芋拿铁，非常适合拍成赏心悦目的 Ins 照。它们的价格也足够亲民，大多数人都消费得起。即使是一颗售价 19 美元的日本进口草莓，偶尔买一次也不会让人倾家荡产。《新消费者》博客的作者丹·弗罗默（Dan Frommer）指出，年轻消费者把大量时间花在社交媒体上，因此也更倾向于追求新奇事物。

inclined adj. /ɪnˈklaɪnd/ (~ to do sth) tending to do sth; likely to do sth 有...倾向；很可能

novelty n. /ˈnɒv(ə)lti/ the quality of being new, different and interesting 新奇；新颖；新鲜

overwhelm v. /ˌəʊvəˈwelɪn/ to have such a strong emotional effect on sb that it is difficult for them to resist or know how to react (感情或感觉) 充溢，难以禁受

She was **overwhelmed** by feelings of guilt. 她感到愧疚难当。

SYN overcome

surge v. /sɜːdʒ/ to suddenly increase in value 急剧上升；飞涨；激增

Electric vehicle sales **surged** last year as more charging stations were installed. 随着更多充电站投入使用，去年电动汽车销量激增。

v. to move quickly and with force in a particular direction 涌；汹涌；涌动

The gates opened and the crowd **surged** forward. 大门打开了，人群向前涌去。

middleman n. /ˈmɪdlmæn/ a person or a company that buys goods from the company that makes them and sells them to sb else 中间商；经销商

mediate v. /ˈmiːdiət/ (~ in sth) (~ between A and B) to try to end a disagreement between two or more people or groups by talking to them and trying to find things that everyone can agree on 调停；调解；斡旋

An independent body was brought in to **mediate** between staff and management. 由一个独立机构介入，在劳资之间进行调解。

v. (formal) to influence sth and/or make it possible for it to happen 影响...的发生；使...可能发生

Educational success is **mediated** by economic factors. 经济因素影响教育的成功。

cope v. /kəʊp/ (~ with sth) to deal successfully with sth difficult (成功地) 对付，处理

He wasn't able to **cope** with the stresses and strains of the job. 对付这项工作的紧张与压力，他无能为力。

SYN manage, handle

lock in phrasal verb to fix or secure something so that it cannot be changed, especially a price, rate, or agreement; also to confine someone or something in a locked space.

(尤指价格、利率或协议) 锁定；把...关在里面

The airline **locked in** fuel prices at a favourable rate for the next two years. 这家航空公司以优惠价格锁定了未来两年的燃油费。

rival n. /ˈraɪv/ (~ to sb/sth) (for sth) a person, company, or thing that competes with another in sport, business, etc. 竞争对手

range n. /reɪndʒ/ (US usually line) the goods made by one company or goods of one particular type that are sold in a shop (某公司生产或某商店出售的) 某一类产品，某一系列产品

We stock the full range of model railway accessories. 我们备有铁路模型玩具的全套零配件。

collaboration n. /kəˌlæbəˈreɪʃn/ (~ with sb) (on sth) (~ between A and B) the act of working with another person or group of people to create or produce sth 合作；协作

【 Para.5 】

Explosive demand has **overwhelmed** supply chains. Tencha leaves, which are used to make matcha, nearly tripled in price between 2024 and 2025 amid **surging** interest in the drink. The bushes from which they come require years to grow. Hot markets also attract chancers. Rocky Xu, a matcha seller in Los Angeles, says that when he ran out last year, he found that the market had become crowded with **middlemen**. The newcomers—mainly Japanese entrepreneurs hoping to **mediate** between farmers and foreign buyers—pushed up prices.

爆炸式增长的需求已经让供应链不堪重负。随着人们对抹茶的兴趣迅速升温，用于制作抹茶的碾茶茶叶价格在 2024 年至 2025 年间上涨了近两倍。而产出这种茶叶的茶树需数年时间才能长成。火爆的市场也会吸引投机者。洛杉矶抹茶销售商洛基·徐（Rocky Xu）表示，去年其抹茶售空时，他发现市场上已经挤满了中间商。不少日本创业者希望撮合农民与外国买家，以他们为主的新加入者进一步推高了价格。

【 Para.6 】

Food companies are trying to **cope** in several ways. Anticipating trends as early as possible allows them to **lock in** suppliers before **rivals** do. Starbucks, an American coffee chain, started offering matcha drinks in 2006, long before the matcha boom in the West. It popularised drinks with “popping pearls” in 2024, before bubble tea went mainstream. More recently it added a protein **range** to its

all the rage idiom (informal) to be very popular and fashionable 十分流行；成为时尚；风靡一时

Long hair for men was **all the rage** in the 70s. 在70年代，男人留长发风靡一时。

embrace v. /ɪmˈbreɪs/ (formal) to put your arms around sb as a sign of love or friendship 抱；拥抱

They **embraced** and promised to **keep in touch**. 他们互相拥抱，许诺将保持联系。

v. (formal) to accept an idea, a proposal, a set of beliefs, etc., especially when it is done with enthusiasm 欣然接受，乐意采纳（思想、建议等）；信奉（宗教、信仰等）

He **embraces** the new information age. 他欢迎新的信息时代。

v. (formal) to include sth 包括；包含

The talks **embraced** a wide range of issues. 这些谈话涉及的问题非常广泛。

pull v. /pʊl/ to remove or stop something that was going to be published or broadcast, especially because it is found to be offensive or not accurate （尤指因为有冒犯性或不准确）撤下即将出版（或传播）的材料

When officials realized the cultural gaffe, the company **pulled** the ad and apologized. 当官员们意识到文化上的失礼后，撤下了广告并作了道歉。

laxative adj. /ˈlæksətɪv/ a medicine, food or drink that makes sb empty their bowels easily 轻泻药；通便剂；有通便作用的饮食

Foods that ferment quickly in the stomach are excellent natural **laxatives**. 在胃里快速发酵的食物是极好的天然泻药。

coffees, which are now as popular as flat whites in Europe.

Louise Direito, an executive at the chain, says that it has switched from relying on “small focus groups” to tracking “millions of customers shaping trends in real time” on the internet. “The challenge is knowing when to join the conversation, as well as when it’s too late,” she adds.

食品企业正尝试通过多种方式应对现状。尽可能早地预测食品潮流，可以让它们抢在竞争对手之前锁定供应商。美国咖啡连锁品牌星巴克早在 2006 年就开始提供抹茶饮品，远早于西方抹茶热潮。2024 年，在珍珠奶茶成为主流之前，它就推广了添加爆珠的饮品。最近，星巴克又在咖啡产品中加入了高蛋白系列。如今，这类饮品在欧洲已经可以与馥芮白分庭抗礼。星巴克高管路易丝·迪雷托（Louise Direito）表示，公司已从以“小型焦点小组”为主的模式转向通过互联网追踪“数百万正在实时塑造潮流的消费者”。她补充道：“挑战在于，既要知道何时介入话题正当时，也要知道何时入局实属太晚。”

【 Para.7 】

Collaborations also help. As spicy instant ramyeon noodles became **all the rage** in 2022, fast-food chains lined up to work with Fly by Jing, a trendy maker of chilli-oil. Shake Shack, a burger chain, built a whole chicken menu around it.

合作也有助力。2022 年，随着辛辣方便面风靡一时，各大快餐连锁品牌纷纷寻求与时尚辣椒油品牌 Fly by

今日句子分析

Para. 3 Swiss fondue, a hit with Americans in the 1960s and 70s, resulted in millions of cheese-melting pots that now languish in cupboards. 20世纪60年代和70年代，瑞士奶酪火锅风靡美国，催生出的融奶酪锅数以百万计，而如今，其大多只能在橱柜中闲置。



主句：

主语：Swiss fondue；（所谓瑞士奶酪火锅就是把不同种类的奶酪放进一个锅里加热、融化，用叉子叉着面包、蔬菜等食物蘸进融化的奶酪里吃，形式类似火锅。）

同位语：a hit；后置定语：with Americans；（hit在这里是常见名词用法，表示“热门产品/作品/现象”，译文调整为了“风靡”。本句使用a hit with sb结构，也就是用with连接了受欢迎的对象。hit最常用于形容文娱作品：She has released several hit songs.（她发行过几首热门歌曲。），也可形容成功的产品或活动：The new restaurant has been a big hit.（这家新餐厅非常受欢迎。），The app became a surprise hit.（这款App意外走红。）在此基础上可再积累一个常见表达：an instant hit “一经推出就大受欢迎”或“迅速走红”，在互联网语境中和go viral含义类似。

类似表达还有①go down well with（流行，反响很好）：The idea went down well with the audience.

②appeal to（吸引）：The product appeals to younger consumers.

③be well received by（电影、产品、政策等受好评）：The film was well received by critics.）

时间状语：in the 1960s and 70s；

谓语：resulted in；宾语：millions of cheese-melting pots；（表示“导致”的常见表达：lead to/cause/give rise to/bring about（社会、技术、制度等变化），result in则相对正式。）

定语从句（修饰pots）：

主语：that；时间状语：now；谓语：languish；地点状语：in cupboards；（languish表示衰弱、没有活力、无人关注，在这里形容锅，有种拟人化的意味，表示它们被遗忘、被长期闲置。）

Jing 合作。汉堡连锁品牌 Shake Shack 甚至围绕这种辣椒油打造了一整套鸡肉餐单。

【 Para.8 】

But not all fads are worth **embracing**. Starbucks' olive-oil coffees were **pulled** from menus in America and Canada less than a year after their launch in 2024—amid complaints about **laxative** effects.

但并非所有潮流都值得追捧。星巴克的橄榄油咖啡于 2024 年推出后还不到一年，便因消费者投诉其具有类似泻药的效果，从美国和加拿大的菜单中撤下。

➤ 写作积累

1. (Para. 1) Dairies have not scaled up cheese production to match.

scale up 表示 “to increase the size, amount, production, or importance of something, usually in a systematic or proportional way”，即“扩大规模、提高产量、扩充生产能力”，例如，They plan to scale up production of the new electric car next year. 他们计划明年扩大新款电动汽车的生产规模。此外，还有以下习语可以表示相同的含义：

fire on all cylinders idiom to operate or perform at your absolute highest, most effective, and most energetic level 全力运转；火力全开；处于最佳运转状态

Factories were firing on all cylinders to keep up with demand. 工厂正开足马力运转，以跟上需求。

go into overdrive idiom to start working, operating, or thinking at a much faster, harder, or more intense level than usual 全速运转；加大力度；超常运作

Production went into overdrive as demand surged. 随着需求激增，生产进入了高速运转状态。

2. (Para. 5) Rocky Xu, a matcha seller in Los Angeles, says that when he ran out last year, he found that the market had become crowded with middlemen.

本句中的 ran out 表示 “to use up, finish, or reach the expiration of something”，即“某物用完，耗尽，库存告罄”，例如，I ran out of milk. 我们的牛奶喝完了。此外，还有以下表达可以表示类似的含义：

be out of stock idiom a product is temporarily or permanently unavailable for purchase because a store or seller has sold all of their current supply 缺货，断货，无现货

I am sorry that the book you ordered is out of stock. 很抱歉，你订购的那本书目前缺货。

be picked clean idiom to be completely emptied, stripped of all contents, or left with nothing remaining 把某物拿得一点不剩；一扫而空

By the time the lions finished, the carcass had been picked clean. 当狮子们吃完时，动物的残骸已被剔得干干净净。